



Division

DIVISION INVOLVES FINDING OUT HOW MANY TIMES ONE NUMBER GOES INTO ANOTHER NUMBER.

There are two ways to think about division. The first is sharing a number out equally (10 coins to 2 people is 5 each). The other is dividing a number into equal groups (10 coins into piles containing 2 coins each is 5 piles).

How division works

Dividing one number by another finds out how many times the second number (the divisor) fits into the first (the dividend). For example, dividing 10 by 2 finds out how many times 2 fits into 10. The result of the division is known as the quotient.



◁ Division symbols

There are three main symbols for division that all mean the same thing. For example, "6 divided by 3" can be expressed as $6 \div 3$, $6/3$, or $\frac{6}{3}$.

▽ Division as sharing

Sharing equally is one type of division. Dividing 4 candies equally between 2 people means that each person gets the same number of candies: 2 each.



$$4 \text{ CANDIES} \div 2 \text{ PEOPLE} = 2 \text{ CANDIES PER PERSON}$$

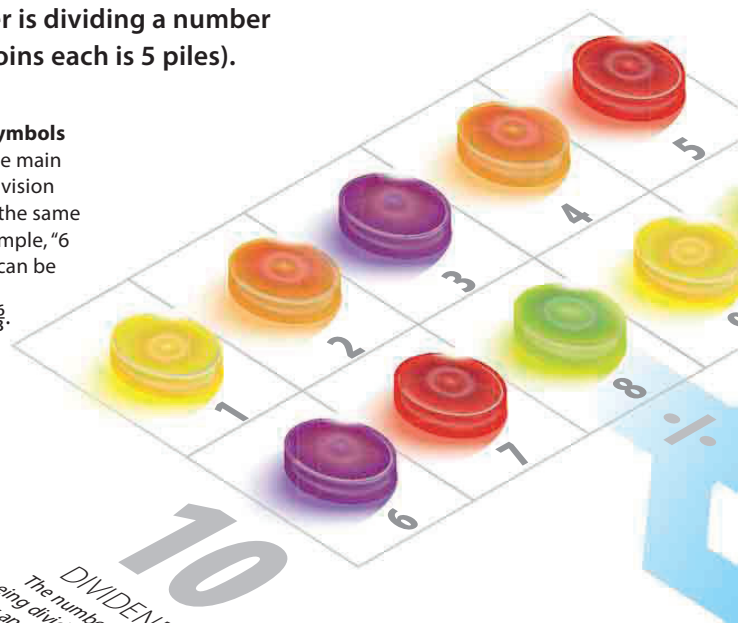
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◀ 18–21 Multiplication

Ratio and proportion

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DIVIDEND
The number that is being divided or shared by another number



LOOKING CLOSER

How division is linked to multiplication

Division is the direct opposite or "inverse" of multiplication, and the two are always connected. If you know the answer to a particular division, you can form a multiplication from it and vice versa.

$$10 \div 2 = 5 \quad 5 \times 2 = 10$$

◁ Back to the beginning

If 10 (the dividend) is divided by 2 (the divisor), the answer (the quotient) is 5. Multiplying the quotient (5) by the divisor of the original division problem (2) results in the original dividend (10).

DIVISOR
The number that is being used to divide the dividend